

Internal Sales Pipeline — Stages & Exit Criteria

The pipeline your own sales run on, with a clear exit criterion at every stage.

Pack 10 — Internal CRM & Pipeline

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(SalesOps CRM)

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Document	Internal Sales Pipeline — Stages & Exit Criteria
Purpose	Define the pipeline stages and gates so forecasting and coaching are objective.
Status	Build-now · Method
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BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Run a simple, gated pipeline with an **objective exit criterion at every stage** — a deal only advances when the criterion is met, never on optimism. This keeps the forecast honest and shows exactly where deals stall. (Fittingly, you run this in SalesOps CRM itself — you use what you sell.)

Pipeline stages

Stage	Exit criterion (must be true to advance)
1. New lead	ICP-fit confirmed (Pack 06)
2. Contacted	Two-way conversation happened
3. Discovery done	2+ pains quantified; economic buyer identified (Pack 09)
4. Demo held	Prospect saw their workflow solved live
5. Trial active	Data migrated; team using it by day 7 (Pack 12)
6. Won	Contract signed via e-signature
— Lost / nurture	Reason logged (feeds win/loss learning, Pack 04)

WHY EXIT CRITERIA MATTER

Stages defined by **evidence** ("prospect saw X"), not feeling ("seems keen"), make the forecast trustworthy and reveal the true bottleneck. If deals pile up at Stage 4 → 5, the problem is the trial start, not lead volume — and you fix the right thing.

Implication

This pipeline drives the KPI dashboard and forecasting (this Pack) and the SOPs (Pack 12). It is deliberately simple — a lean team needs clarity, not a 12-stage bureaucracy.

Sources & confidence

Claim	Source	Confidence
Stage/gate design	standard SaaS practice + Pack 09	 Reasoned